

Cross-Cultural Peer Feedback: Extra Credit

The purpose of this assignment is to use what you have learned in SpCm 2120 to help others who have fewer opportunities to develop their public speaking skills. Since 2014 when the ongoing civil war broken out in Yemen between the Houthi rebels and the Presidential Leadership Council, university students there have had limited opportunities to improve their public speaking and English language skills. Many members of their academic communities who spoke English as their first language, including both professors and students, have been unable to return to campus, taking opportunities for learning and cross-cultural interaction with them. To provide Yemeni students with some of the opportunities they have lost, the U.S. State Department is funding a group of motivated Yemeni college students as they produce the [Qisasna](#) podcast. Each episode is the product of remote collaboration between Yemeni college students and American college students, and focuses on commonalities between life in Yemen and life in the United States. For example, episodes have focused on the pandemic, gun ownership, and differences between Generation Z and their parents.

For this extra credit assignment, you will listen to a podcast episode before the Qisasna team publishes it. You will give them feedback using the form below on their episode, focusing on what they have done well, and what they could improve, drawing on the criteria we have covered this semester. Based on your feedback, the Qisasna team of Yemeni students will revise their episode before publishing it on Apple Podcasts.

You may submit this extra credit assignment once, to earn up to 10 points extra credit.

Instructions:

- *Take notes while listening to the episode. You will need specific information to write meaningful feedback. You may want to include timestamps with specific feedback.*
- *Responses should be in the form of complete sentences and in paragraph form (3 sentences minimum).*

Constructive Feedback (3 pts.)

1. Assess the episode's Introduction. In your assessment, how effectively did it gain your attention? How effectively did they preview their ideas?

So, I listened to the podcast on Social Influencers, and immediately the hook caught my attention. It's a very relevant topic and is very prevalent especially to some in my age demographic. It does seem like they portray social media as a sort of evil from the start. So I would expect them to take this standpoint during their podcast.

2. List the main points of the episode. Were the main points well developed (e.g. well supported with facts, stories, testimony, etc.)? Overall, did the team present a well-organized episode?

- Instagrams effect on society
- Personal Experiences
- Addiction to Social Media (Instagram)

3. Assess the episode's conclusion and address the following: How effectively did they signal the end of their episode? How effectively did they reinforce their thesis/central idea?

They finished with a very important note telling listeners to "live their life" and how if you spend all your time worrying about followers or scrolling you are like an inanimate object. I think this is a very good thought-provoking finish and will allow the audience to reflect on their actions better. It also aligns with their original opening attitude of social media being largely a waste of time.

Delivery (2 pts.)

What were the strengths of the team's **oral delivery** (including volume, rate, articulation, delivery style, vocal variety)? Were there any weaknesses? Explain, and please be specific (including timestamps, if applicable) if you have suggestions that could improve the episode before their final recording.

One of the microphones for the speaker was poor and struggled to pick up good audio (9:52). The transition between commentators was done very well and seamlessly. Also, the music before and after the talk was a nice feature.

Audience (2 pt.)

How was the **information adapted for the speaker's American audience**? Should they include any additional information to help listeners in the U.S. understand the episode?

The content itself is somewhat geared toward American culture as Instagram is very deep rooted in younger Americans culture. There was also context given and a student from Utah as a figure for someone who lives in America.

Part II: Positive Feedback (3 pts)

- What did the team do well? Please be specific

They were able to find a very interesting topic to talk about and give a new perspective from which you might not have thought of originally.

- Could you relate to the episode? Did you learn new information?
Yes, I could see the importance of addressing how Instagram could be harmful for it's users. Also, how important it's to acknowledge the benefits and negatives that come with Instagram.